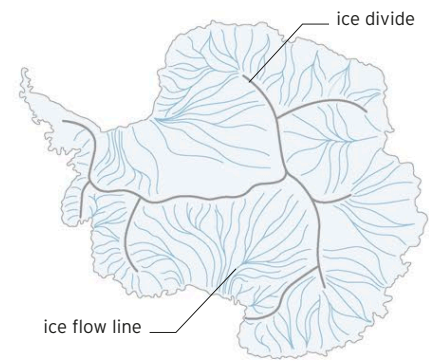


Several hundred lakes lie under the ice sheet and on top of the continental crust beneath it

ICE FLOW LINES

Snow falling on the Antarctic Ice Sheet compacts to form ice. Under the force of its own weight, this ice slowly deforms and moves toward the coasts along the flow lines. Imaginary lines called ice divides separate regions of ice moving toward different coasts.



△ ABOVE THE ICE

In the upper Taylor Valley, which lies in the Transantarctic Mountains, the spectacular Taylor Glacier—an outlet glacier from the East Antarctic Ice Sheet—is channeled by the mountains down toward the Ross Sea.



High point

The highest area on the ice sheet, called Dome Argus, is more than 13,000 ft (4,000 m) above sea level.



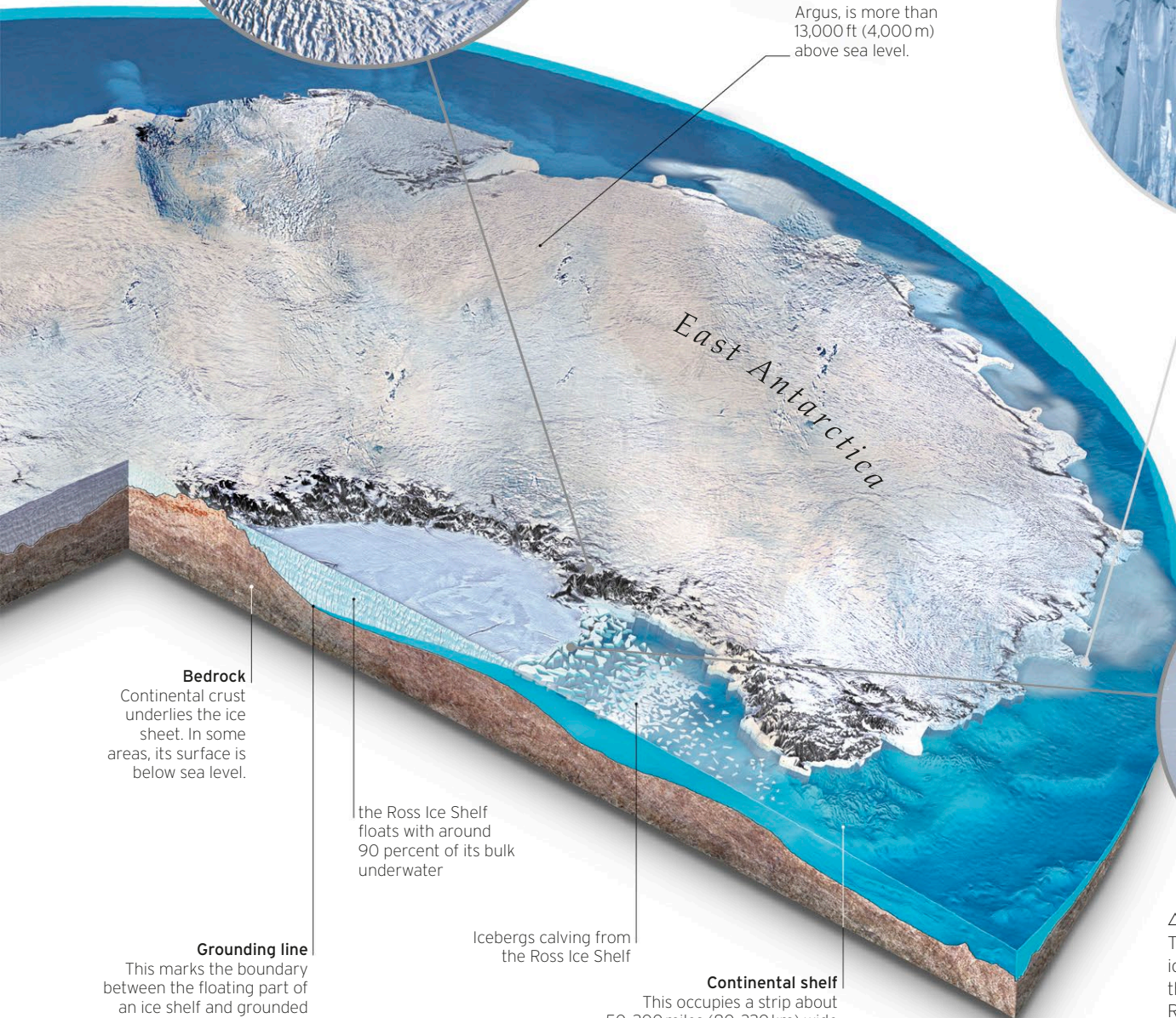
△ CLIFFS OF ICE

The Mertz Glacier ends in an ice tongue that protrudes about 12-15 miles (20-25 km) over the Southern Ocean. At its terminus are cliffs that tower as much as 165 ft (50 m) above the sea surface.



△ ROSS ICE SHELF

The world's largest ice shelf, with an ice cliff along its edge that is more than 370 miles (600 km) long, the Ross Ice Shelf (see p.308) has a total area of about 188,000 square miles (487,000 square km).



Bedrock

Continental crust underlies the ice sheet. In some areas, its surface is below sea level.

the Ross Ice Shelf floats with around 90 percent of its bulk underwater

Grounding line

This marks the boundary between the floating part of an ice shelf and grounded ice feeding into it.

Icebergs calving from the Ross Ice Shelf

Continental shelf

This occupies a strip about 50-200 miles (80-320 km) wide around the whole of Antarctica.